BEST MAN BACKUP · FREE GUIDE

The Best Man's 1-Page Speech Cheat Sheet

Everything that matters, on one page. Pin it up, then start writing.

01 · THE STRUCTURE

Five parts. In this order.

1. **Open.** Who you are and how you know him, in one line. Thank the hosts if no one else has.
2. **The groom.** Pick one quality you genuinely rate in him. Just one.
3. **The story.** One true moment that shows that quality: the scene, what happened, the detail you still laugh about, and why it matters.
4. **The couple.** What changed when they met. Welcome his partner warmly, by name.
5. **The toast.** Ask everyone to stand, raise a glass and name the couple. Then sit down.

02 · FIVE OPENING LINES

Start strong. Adapt one.

"For those who don't know me, I'm [name]. I've known [groom] since [when], which means I know far too much. Don't worry, most of it stays with me."

"When [groom] asked me to be best man, I said yes straight away. Then he mentioned the speech."

"I've been asked to keep this short, so I've cut everything about [harmless habit]. That leaves about four minutes."

"[Groom] and I have been friends for [number] years. In that time he's taught me a lot. Mostly about [harmless thing]."

"Before I start, on behalf of [partner] and [groom], thank you all for being here today."

03 · THE TIMING RULE

Five to seven minutes.

650 to 900 words

That's roughly what you'll say in five to seven minutes at a calm, unhurried pace, with room for laughs.

Time yourself out loud, not in your head. If you run over, cut a story, not the toast.

04 · THINGS NEVER TO SAY

Leave these out.

- Exes, past partners or "the one before".
- Stag do stories that need "you had to be there", or that would embarrass anyone in the room.
- "Ball and chain" jokes, or anything about the marriage not lasting.
- Digs at either family, or at the cost of the wedding.
- Secrets the couple don't know you're about to share.
- In-jokes only three people will get.
- "I'm not good at speeches." Skip the apology and start.
- Anything you wouldn't say in front of his grandmother.

The test: would he laugh at it too, and would his partner be glad you said it?

Want the full method?

The Best Man Speech Kit takes you from scattered memories to a finished speech you can deliver: a speech-writing guide, an editable Word workbook, a final-speech document, six large cue cards and a rehearsal checklist. Find it in the Best Man Backup shop on Etsy: **etsy.com/uk/listing/4567367337**